PO-AN CHEN

CURRICULUM VITAE

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EDUCATION

University of Florida, Gainesville, FL **2021–Present**
Ph.D., Interdisciplinary Ecology

National Chung Hsing University, Taichung, Taiwan **2018**
M.Sc., Life Science

National Chiayi University, Chiayi, Taiwan **2014**
B.Sc., Animal Science

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Doctoral Research, University of Florida, Gainesville, FL **2021–Present**

Advisor: Kathryn E. Sieving

- Investigate how resource quality, social environment, and perceived risk influence vocal communication, information use, and foraging decisions in mixed-species bird groups.
- Design and conduct field experiments with Tufted Titmice (*Baeolophus bicolor*) and Carolina Chickadees (*Poecile carolinensis*), integrating food manipulations, acoustic playbacks, automated acoustic recording, camera monitoring, and behavioral observations.
- Integrate and analyze behavioral, bioacoustic, and environmental data to quantify species-specific vocal and foraging responses across experimental treatments, social contexts, and temporal variation.

Master's Research, National Chung Hsing University, Taichung, Taiwan **2018**

Advisor: Shao-pin Yo

Thesis: *The Study of Habitat Utilization for Granivorous Birds and Their Impacts on the Rice Grain Damage in a Natural Farming Field at Wufeng District in Taichung City*

- Investigated how landscape features and rice-production stages influenced the distribution and abundance of granivorous birds and associated rice-grain damage in a natural-farming rice system.
- Conducted systematic bird surveys and rice-damage assessments across landscape contexts, levee types, rice cropping seasons, and growth stages to inform rice-field management and bird-damage mitigation.

Undergraduate Research Intern, National Taiwan Normal University, Taipei, Taiwan **2012**

Mentor: Si-Min Lin

- Investigated how testosterone levels and resource availability influenced immune function in *Takydromus viridipunctatus* to test predictions of the Immunocompetence Handicap Hypothesis.
- Conducted experimental hormone and feeding manipulations, applied topical testosterone treatments, administered phytohemagglutinin (PHA) immune-response assays, and quantified treatment effects on immune response.

PUBLICATIONS & MANUSCRIPTS

Manuscripts in Preparation

Martin, N. W., Howell, S., **Chen, P. A.**, St. Mary, C., & Sieving, K. E. *Freeze, flee, or fact-find: Modeling avian cognitive-mechanistic responses to heterospecific alarm calls while foraging.* In preparation.

PRESENTATIONS

Conference & Research Presentations

Chen, P. A. & Sieving, K. E. (2026, September). *Who's There Matters: Tufted Titmouse Social Signals and Feeder Use* [Poster presentation]. 2026 Southeastern Conference for Animal Behavior, Knoxville, TN, USA. Also presented at the 2026 SNRE Research Symposium, University of Florida, Gainesville, FL, USA.

Chen, P. A. & Sieving, K. E. (2026, July). *Listening for Food Quality: Species-specific vocal responses in Carolina chickadees and Tufted titmice* [Oral presentation]. 2026 Animal Behavior Society Annual Meeting, Cincinnati, OH, USA.

Chen, P. A. & Sieving, K. E. (2025, July). *Chatter Matters: Parid Calls Reveal Dynamic Information Sampling at Feeders* [Poster presentation]. 2025 Animal Behavior Society Annual Meeting, Baltimore, MD, USA.

Chen, P. A. & Sieving, K. E. (2024, October). *Seets and dees: Exploring the food-related vocalizations of the Tufted Titmouse (Baeolophus bicolor) and the Carolina Chickadee (Poecile carolinensis)* [Poster presentation]. 2024 American Ornithological Society Annual Meeting, Estes Park, CO, USA. Also presented at the 2024 SNRE Research Symposium, University of Florida, Gainesville, FL, USA.

Chen, P. A. (2024). *Preliminary results on the foraging-related vocalizations of birds in the family Paridae* [Poster presentation]. Suds & Science 2024, Wildlife Graduate Student Association, University of Florida, Gainesville, FL, USA.

Chen, P. A. & Sieving, K. E. (2023, November). *Are social birds talking about food? Food-related vocalizations of Tufted Titmouse (Baeolophus bicolor)* [Oral presentation]. Fall 2023 Florida Ornithological Society Meeting, St. Petersburg, FL, USA.

Chen, P. A. & Yo, S. P. (2019, January). *The study of habitat utilization for granivorous birds and their impacts on the rice grain damage in a natural farming field at Wufeng District in Taichung City* [Poster presentation]. 2019 Congress of Animal Behavior and Ecology, Taipei City, Taiwan.

Lin, J. W., Luo, C. H., Lee, K. H., Tseng, W. H., **Chen, P. A.**, & Lin, S. M. (2013, January). *Costs of Being Charming: Tests of the Immunocompetence Handicap Hypothesis in Takydromus viridipunctatus* [Poster presentation]. 2013 Symposium on Animal Behavior and Ecology, Hualien County, Taiwan.

Invited Presentations

Chen, P. A. (2022). *Influence of food quality and audience effects on functionally referential food calls in Paridae - a brief prospectus.* Invited speaker, ERASMUS+ exchange program, Faculty of Biology, University of Latvia.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Graduate Teaching Assistant, School of Natural Resources & Environment **2024–2025**
University of Florida
IDS2935 – Quest 2: Why Maps Matter — Spring 2024; Spring 2025

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Department of Wildlife Ecology & Conservation **2021–2026**
University of Florida
WIS2040 – Wildlife Issues — Summer 2026
WIS2552 – Biodiversity Conservation: Global Perspectives — Summer 2026
WIS4570C – Wildlife Behavior and Conservation — Fall 2021; Fall 2023; Fall 2024; Fall 2025
WIS4547C – Avian Field Research — Spring 2023
WIS3401 – Wildlife Ecology and Management — Fall 2022

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Department of Life Science **2015–2018**
National Chung Hsing University
Laboratory in Ornithology — 2015–2018
Ecological Impact Analysis — 2017

MENTORING EXPERIENCE

Student Mentor, Student Science Training Program (SSTP) **2024**
University of Florida
- Mentored two high school students in acoustic data processing, data management, statistical analysis, and scientific presentation.

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Great Teaching Certificate, University of Florida Center for Teaching Excellence **September 2025**

CIRTL Associate Certificate, University of Florida Center for Teaching Excellence **September 2025**

Inclusive Mentoring Academy in Graduate Education (IMAGE), University of Florida Center for Teaching Excellence **July 2025**

AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS

Best Poster Presentation, 2024 SNRE Research Symposium, University of Florida **2024**

Werner and Hildegard Hesse Research Award, American Ornithological Society **2022**

Graduate Student Summer Fellowship, University of Florida Biodiversity Institute **2022**

Grinter Fellowship, University of Florida Graduate School **2021**

GRADUATE ADVISORS

Kathryn E. Sieving, University of Florida **Ph.D.**

Shao-pin Yo, National Chung Hsing University **M.Sc.**